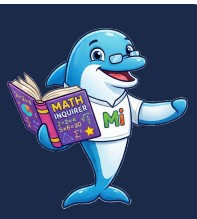
TUTOR NOTES • LEVEL 1 • TERM 4 • MI'S CHALLENGE QUEST

Mi's Challenge Quest



8 gates, one from each lesson of the year, all at Start here level, plus one optional secret cave item. 20 minutes after the break, played in pairs or as a group quest with Mi, working on private paper. It is a game: no score or mark is shown to the child, no ranking, no visible timer. You keep private notes only. For the tutor: do not hand these notes to families.

Where it sits. Lesson 40 (the last lesson of the year), minutes 35 to 55, the part Mi's Challenge Quest, straight after the brain break; or at the make-up slot. The end-of-year slot is a game with Mi, not a test. The group plays it in pairs (a child and a quest partner) or as a group quest with Mi, on private paper. No score or mark is shown to the child, there is no ranking and no visible timer. The tutor keeps private notes only, for one line to each grown-up and for advice for the next program. It keeps the 20-minute slot after the break: 8 short gates and one optional secret cave item, all at Start here level except the key of 2 in gate 6 (taught in Lesson 38 and said plainly on the grown-up note). Lessons 31 and 32 share gate 1 and Lessons 37 and 38 share gate 6, so every lesson of Term 4 is still visited. Gate 8 asks the child to check a puzzle a child in another class wrote, which is the claim-testing the year line talks about. The secret cave joins two ideas the group has met (money in cents and a growing pattern) in an unseen way. A middle child needs about 17 minutes of reading aloud and quiet work; a slower child may use a few minutes of the workbook time to finish. The Quest sits straight after the brain break so children are fresh. The Quest Log carries the Term 4 pictures (a folded circle, a rectangle of squares, a dot grid, a stack of cubes, a folded paper, four tiles, a network of lines and a picture graph). The year look-back (a minute, no scores) is the OUR YEAR card on the last Quest slide. Time is written as digits where it appears; money with the cent sign.

1. The gates at a glance

Gate	From	Area (tutor label)	What it uses (Start here level)	Answer
1	L31, 32	Shapes; fractions as words	Halves and quarters of a circle, and a rectangle made of squares (Lessons 31 and 32)	**4; quarter; 6**
2	L33	Position and space	Steps and routes on a dot grid (Lesson 33)	**3; 3**
3	L34	Position and space	Cubes in a stack, and a paper folded once and punched once (Lesson 34)	**6; 2**
4	L35	Process skills; Whole numbers	The odd one out and what is different (Lesson 35)	**C; number**
5	L36	Process skills; Whole numbers	Counting lines and equal groups (Lesson 36)	**6; 12**
6	L37, 38	Statistics; Process skills	Reading a picture graph with each picture standing for 2 (Lessons 37 and 38)	**6; 4**
7	L39	Statistics; Process skills	Choose a tool: a growing pattern in a table (Lesson 39)	**Table; 17**
8	L40	Statistics; Process skills	Check a friend's puzzle (Lesson 40)	**No; 8**
Secret cave	unseen	unseen puzzle	Saving 5 cents more each day (money in cents and a growing pattern joined) (optional)	**25¢; 75¢**

The area labels are for the tutor only and never appear on a child or parent page. Each gate is a fresh example of the Start here idea of its lesson (numbers chosen so that they do not repeat a lesson page), so a child who followed the lesson can open it. Before first use, read each gate against what the lesson actually taught.

2. Playing it: before and during

1. A week before: send the grown-up note (L40_Quest_Parent_Note.pdf). The Quest Log (4 pages) is in each child's Term 4 book (Book 8): families keep it closed in an envelope and find a quest partner (a grown-up or a brother or sister). A family whose book has a missing or damaged Quest Log page tells you: arrange another way (for example the make-up slot, with L40_Quest_Log.pdf sent to the family another way, as a PDF straight away).
2. Tell the group in the opening and at slide s-quest1: this is Mi's Challenge Quest, a game with Mi. Everyone works on their own paper with a quest partner beside them. It is not a race, a gate may be skipped, and nothing is shown to the group.
3. Start at minute 35 (straight after the brain break) and finish by minute 55. Children open the Quest Log only when you say. The paper lies flat on the table and is never held up. The quest partner may talk about how to start and ask 'how do you know?', but

does not give answers. Cameras may be on or off. Use your own watch out of sight of the camera: no clock, countdown or timer is ever shown to the children.

4. Read each page aloud, one gate at a time (the script has the words), then leave quiet working time: about 2.5 minutes for page 1, 3 for page 2, 2.5 for page 3 and 3 for page 4. After each page say that the gates are open and Mi swims on, whatever the answers. Say nothing about right or wrong, and read no answers. A middle child needs about 17 minutes in all; a slower child may finish in the first minutes of the workbook.
5. Allowed: fingers, counters and talk with the quest partner. Not allowed: a calculator, a grown-up giving answers, looking at the workbook. A child who finishes early turns the Quest Log over and draws quietly.
6. After page 2, take a one-minute stretch (stand, shake out, sip water). After page 4, show slide s-quest2 and look back over the year in a minute with the OUR YEAR card (no scores, no comparing). Do not collect or look at any Quest Log. While children work, notice (do not write on the shared screen) how they start: counters, a picture, a list, talking to the partner.

3. After the lesson: photos and your private notes

1. Same day: the grown-up takes ONE clear photo of each of the 4 pages (page flat, taken straight from above, the whole page in view, and the name on each page) and sends them to the program's business WhatsApp, +65 9880 5962, and to no other number. Never to a child, never to a personal phone, never into the class chat.
2. Within 3 days: open the photos only on the business WhatsApp (never on a personal phone) and write your private notes (section 5) for each child, from the photos and what you saw on camera. Section 4 shows what each answer tells you; accept either order of the two routes you see in gate 2, and a table or a strip in gate 7 part a. Nothing is written on the child's paper, nothing is added up and no order of children is made. Nothing about the Quest goes back to the child or the group except thanks.
3. Write ONE line for each grown-up from your notes (section 7): what we saw, in plain words, and one small next step if it helps. It is sent to the parent only. No marks, no x out of 8, no ranking, no comparison with other children, no prediction.
4. Fill in the group advice sheet (section 6): what several children were still working on, with no names, and what you will do in the first lessons of the next program. It is kept for the next tutor and is never shown to families.
5. Once the line is sent, save the photos to the program's private file store and delete them from the business WhatsApp chat. The program keeps the photos for 90 days after the program ends, then deletes them, as the privacy notice says. Delete each child's notes sheet when the line is sent (keep only the line in the family file, and the group advice sheet). Never forward the photos or save them to a personal phone or any other device.
6. At the start of the next program say to the whole group: thank you for playing Mi's Challenge Quest; there is nothing to share and nothing to fear. Never name a child or an answer.

Privacy checklist

- Quest Logs are never held up to the camera and never read out.
- No answer is said aloud during or after the Quest. Gates open for everyone, whatever the answers.
- No clock, countdown or timer is shown; nobody is told who finished first or last.
- Photos come to the program's business WhatsApp (+65 9880 5962) only; tutors never use a personal phone; photos are kept 90 days after the program ends, then deleted; the line goes to the parent only; no private message to any child.
- No score, no x out of 8, no ranking, no tally, no comparison between children, not even in your own notes.
- The recording captures the tutor, the shared screen and any voice that is not muted: the recording is paused for the whole Quest (slides s-quest1 and s-quest2) and restarted for the workbook. The WhatsApp number is never on a slide.

Absent, late joiners, families who prefer not to, upset children

- A child who was away or whose family prefers another time: plays the Quest at the make-up slot BEFORE watching the recording (the Quest is not on the recording, so no gate is given away). It is a small group or a pair with Mi, with a parent beside the child on camera. The tutor never sits alone with one child on a private call.
- A child who joined late: the family may choose to leave out gates for lessons the child did not attend. Write nothing for those gates; if no gate of an area was taught, the line for the grown-up says nothing about that area.
- A family that does not want the Quest: no problem. The child does the Lesson 40 work as usual and the line for the grown-up uses your own notes from the lessons only.
- A child who is upset or stuck: remind the group (open session) that every gate can be skipped and Mi swims round it. Do not single the child out. The grown-up may stop the Quest at any time.
- A family whose Quest Log is missing or damaged: tell the family to say so a week before and arrange another way (for example the make-up slot, with L40_Quest_Log.pdf sent to the family another way). Never ask a child about it in front of the group.

4. Answers and what to look for

Use these to understand what you see on camera and in the photos. Nothing is written on the child's paper, nothing is totalled and no gate is marked right or wrong in front of anyone. A child may write steps in any clear layout. Spelling and neatness do not matter.

Gate 1 (L31, 32) A circle is folded in half and in half again. A rectangle is made of 2 rows of 3 squares.
Answer: 4; quarter; 6
(a) The circle has __ equal parts. = 4; (b) Each part is called a __ . = quarter; (c) The rectangle has __ squares in all. = 6
A secure answer looks like: All three correct. **Half way there:** Two of the three correct.
Worked: Half and half again makes 4 equal parts, and each part is a quarter. 2 rows of 3 squares: 3 and 3 make 6 squares.
Watch for: (a) 2 (only one fold counted).; (b) half.; (c) 5 (adding 2 and 3).

Gate 2 (L33) A counter starts at S. It moves only right or up to reach E.
Answer: 3; 3
(a) It moves __ steps in all. = 3; (b) There are __ different routes from S to E. = 3
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: 2 steps right and 1 step up make 3 steps. The routes are right right up, right up right, and up right right: 3 routes.
Watch for: (a) 2 (counting only the right steps).; (b) 1 or 2 (only one route found).

Gate 3 (L34) Look at the stack of cubes. Then look at the folded paper.
Answer: 6; 2
(a) There are __ cubes in all. = 6; (b) The paper is folded in half once and one hole is punched. When it is opened there are __ holes. = 2
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: The stacks have 2, 2, 1 and 1 cubes: 2 and 2 make 4, and 1 and 1 more make 6 cubes. A folded paper has 2 layers, so one hole goes through both: 2 holes.
Watch for: (a) 4 or 5 (a hidden cube not counted).; (b) 1 (the second layer forgotten).

Gate 4 (L35) Three tiles are alike. One tile is the odd one out.
Answer: C; number
(a) Circle the odd one out: A, B, C or D. = C; (b) Circle what is different: shape, number, size or pattern. = number
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: Tiles A, B and D each have 2 triangles. Tile C has 3 triangles, so it is the odd one out, and the number is different.
Watch for: (a) A, B or D (one of the alike tiles).; (b) shape or size (looking at the wrong feature).

Gate 5 (L36) Each line joins two dots. 4 bags have 3 sweets in each bag.
Answer: 6; 12
(a) There are __ lines. = 6; (b) The 4 bags have __ sweets in all. = 12
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: Count each line once: 6 lines. 4 bags of 3 sweets: 3, 6, 9, 12 sweets.
Watch for: (a) 5 or 7 (a line missed or counted twice).; (b) 7 (adding 4 and 3).

Gate 6 (L37, 38) Look at the graph. Each picture stands for 2 stickers.
Answer: 6; 4
(a) Ali has __ stickers. = 6; (b) Mei has __ more stickers than Ali. = 4
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: Ali has 3 pictures: 2, 4, 6 stickers. Mei has 5 pictures, which is 2 more pictures than Ali, and 2 pictures of 2 are 4 more stickers.
Watch for: (a) 3 (counting pictures, not stickers).; (b) 2 (2 more pictures, not 4 more stickers).

Gate 7 (L39) A tower has 5 blocks in row 1, 8 blocks in row 2 and 11 blocks in row 3. Each row has 3 more blocks than the row before.
Answer: Table; 17
(a) Circle the tool that fits best: Strip, Table or Work backwards. = Table; (b) Row 5 has __ blocks. = 17
A secure answer looks like: Both correct (a strip is a sensible second choice for part a). **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: The numbers grow by 3 each time, so a table fits: 5, 8, 11, 14, 17. Row 5 has 17 blocks.
Watch for: (a) Work backwards.; (b) 14 (row 4) or 20 (row 6).

Gate 8 (L40) A child in another class wrote a puzzle: I think of a number. I add 5. I get 13. My number is 7.

Answer: No; 8

(a) Is the puzzle right? Circle Yes or No. (Yes / No) = No; (b) The right number is __ . = 8

A secure answer looks like: No and 8. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.

Worked: Check: 7 and 5 make 12, not 13. Work backwards: 13 take away 5 is 8. Check: 8 and 5 make 13.

Watch for: (a) Yes (not checking).; (b) 7 again or 18.

Secret cave (optional) (unseen) Ali saves 5¢ on Monday, 10¢ on Tuesday and 15¢ on Wednesday. Each day he saves 5¢ more than the day before.

Answer: 25¢; 75¢

(a) On Friday he saves __ ¢. = 25; (b) From Monday to Friday he saves __ ¢ in all. = 75

A secure answer looks like: The answer is as above. **Half way there:** -

Worked: Monday 5, Tuesday 10, Wednesday 15, Thursday 20, Friday 25. In all: 5 + 10 + 15 + 20 + 25 = 75 cents.

Watch for: (a) 20 (Thursday).; (b) 25 (only Friday) or 65 (one day left out).

5. Tutor private notes (tutor only; one sheet per child; delete when the line is sent)

Child (first name only): ..... Date: ..... Quest partner: .....

Fill this in after the lesson, from the photos and what you saw on camera. Write what the child did and said in your own words. No ticks for right or wrong, no points, nothing added up. The gate numbers are only reminders of where to look.

Gate	From	What I saw (words used, counters or drawing, how the partner helped, anything the child said)
1	L31, 32	
2	L33	
3	L34	
4	L35	
5	L36	
6	L37, 38	
7	L39	
8	L40	
Cave	unseen	

Prompt	My notes
Something the child did well (a named strength, for example: found every route on the grid by listing them in order)	
How they started: counters, a picture, a list, or in their head	
Where they paused or turned to their partner, and what helped	
One next step for home (small and concrete)	
Did they try the secret cave? (a neutral note only)	

The one line for the grown-up (section 7), written from these notes:

.....

.....

6. Group advice for next term (tutor only; one sheet per class; no names)

When all the notes are written, look across them without names. Write what several children were still working on and how you will use the first two lessons of the next program (a warm-up, a picture, a game). This page never goes to families.

Area	What several children were still working on (no names)	What I will do in the first two lessons of next term
Shapes and parts Lessons 31 to 32: halves and quarters of a circle, and a rectangle made of squares		
Grids and views Lessons 33 to 34: steps and routes on a dot grid, cubes in a stack, and a paper folded and punched		
Spotting and counting Lessons 35 to 36: the odd one out, counting lines, and equal groups		
Graphs, tools and puzzles Lessons 37 to 40: reading a picture graph where each picture stands for 2, choosing a tool, and checking a friend's puzzle		

Prompt	My notes
Gates or ideas where several children paused (no names)	
A warm-up or game to bring back in the first lesson of the next program	
What worked well about the quest as a game, to keep next time	

7. The one line for the grown-up: what we saw

Mi's Challenge Quest: [Name]
In Mi's Challenge Quest, [Name] [one specific thing you saw, in plain words]. [Optional: one small next step at home.]

One or two sentences at most. Say what the child did (counted coins in tens and fives, read a clock to 5 minutes, explained a step), not how many answers were right. Use the lines below as patterns and always add your own detail from your notes.

Area (parent wording)	Things you might have seen (pick the one your notes show; add the detail)	A next step that helps at home
Shapes and parts Lessons 31 to 32. We looked at halves and quarters of a circle, and a rectangle made of squares.	• [Name] folded a circle in half and in half again and found 4 equal parts called quarters. • [Name] counted the squares in a rectangle by rows.	• Fold a paper circle or square in half and in half again, and name the parts. • Count the squares in a bar of chocolate by rows.
Grids and views Lessons 33 to 34. We looked at steps and routes on a dot grid, cubes in a stack, and a paper folded and punched.	• [Name] found the routes on a small grid by listing them in order. • [Name] counted the cubes in a stack and said why a folded paper makes more holes.	• Draw a small dot grid and find every route from one corner to the other. • Fold a paper in half, make one hole with a pencil point on a soft surface, and open it: how many?
Spotting and counting Lessons 35 to 36. We looked at the odd one out, counting lines, and equal groups.	• [Name] named the one thing that was different between tiles. • [Name] counted lines one by one without missing or repeating any.	• Lay out four small things, three alike and one different, and ask what is different. • Count the windows of a building by rows.
Graphs, tools and puzzles Lessons 37 to 40. We looked at reading a picture graph where each picture stands for 2, choosing a tool, and checking a friend's puzzle.	• [Name] read the key first and counted in 2s along a row of pictures. • [Name] chose a table for a pattern and found a later row. • [Name] checked a puzzle clue by clue and found the one that did not fit.	• Draw a graph where each picture stands for 2 and ask your child to read a row. • Write a puzzle with a rule and ask: does it have exactly one answer?

A filled example (fictional child, Mei)

Mi's Challenge Quest: Mei
In Mi's Challenge Quest, Mei folded a circle into quarters and found every route on a small grid by listing them. A good next step: draw a small dot grid and find every route from one corner to the other.

This line describes Mei's own thinking in the game. It does not compare children.

Words to avoid in the line: score, mark, out of, rank, top, below average, behind, ahead of, pass, fail, predicted, ready for. No claim about school exams, GEP or any contest, and no mention of other children. The line goes to the parent only. If the child skipped the secret cave or a gate, say nothing about it. If the child tried the secret cave, you may add: "[Name] also had a go at the secret cave."